MMSU's Commitment

Take an active role in protecting and promoting sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, responsible land use, and biodiversity conservation.

SDG 15.3.5 · Collaboration for shared land ecosystems

Collaborate with the local community to maintain shared land ecosystems.

Evidence year: 2025 (calendar year)

MMSU, TMP Foundation, DENR and Pasuquin LGU Sign Agreement to Conserve a Coastal Forest



Signing of the memorandum of agreement among MMSU, TMP Foundation, DENR and LGU-Pasuquin, 29 November 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)



MMSU, TMP Foundation, DENR and LGU-Pasuquin officials at the agreement signing, 29 November 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)

On November 29, 2025, Mariano Marcos State University, the Toyota Motor Philippines Foundation (TMPF), the Department of Environment and Natural Resources and the Local Government Unit of Pasuquin formalized through a memorandum of agreement a partnership to strengthen coastal forest conservation in Barangay Davila, Pasuquin, Ilocos Norte. The agreement was signed by MMSU President Virgilio Julius P. Manzano Jr. with TMPF leadership, Toyota Motor Philippines and Toyota Ilocos Norte executives, DENR-CENRO Bangui Ecosystem Management Specialist Justine Rose Teneza, and Sangguniang Bayan Member Romel Ranay for LGU-Pasuquin.

A mangrove planting followed the signing, with 1,750 propagules planted and another 1,750 planned for the following year. TMPF President Jose Maria Aligada described the partnership as shared stewardship to restore native mangrove species, rehabilitate coastal systems and boost community resilience to climate-related hazards. Former MMSU College of Industrial Technology Dean Cesario Pacis was recognized as one of the initiators of the MMSU–Toyota partnership.

Source

- MMSU News, "MMSU ties up with Toyota and DENR for coastal preservation in Pasuquin town," 4 December 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-ties-up-with-toyota-and-denr-for-coastal-preservation-in-pasuquin-town
- The Manila Times, "TMP Foundation adopts mangrove forest for climate mitigation," 10 December 2025 https://www.manilatimes.net/2025/12/10/tmt-newswire/tmp-foundation-adopts-mangrove-forest-for-climate-mitigation/2239598

MMSU, Rotary Club and Badoc LGU Restore a Typhoon-Damaged Mangrove Stand



MMSU, Rotary Club of Laoag Sunshine and LGU-Badoc plant mangrove propagules in Brgy. Pagsanahan, Badoc, 6 December 2025. (Photo: MMSU)



Participants of the mangrove enhancement and growing activity in Badoc, 6 December 2025. (Photo: MMSU)

On December 6, 2025, Mariano Marcos State University, the Rotary Club of Laoag Sunshine and the Local Government Unit of Badoc planted 280 mangrove propagules in Barangay Pagsanahan, Badoc, Ilocos Norte, to restore a mangrove stand extensively damaged by past typhoons and to ensure the continuity of ecological succession at the site.

The activity was led by MMSU President Virgilio Julius P. Manzano Jr., with the LGU of Badoc headed by Hon. Virgilio M. Calajate and the Rotary Club of Laoag Sunshine under Atty. Zsa Zsa Raval. MMSU's Vice President for Resource Generation and its Directors for Extension, Curriculum Development and Innovative Learning, and Student Affairs and Development also took part.

Source

- MMSU News, "MMSU ties up with Rotary Club of Laoag Sunshine for mangrove planting in Badoc town," 11 December 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-ties-up-with-rotary-club-of-laoag-sunshine-for-mangrove-planting-in-badoc-town

MMSU Plants 250 Mangrove Propagules in Currimao on World Environment Day



Mangrove planting for World Environment Day, Brgy. Maglaoi, Currimao, June 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)



MMSU, LGU Currimao, DENR and fisherfolk volunteers at the planting site, June 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)

In June 2025, in celebration of World Environment Day, Mariano Marcos State University planted 250 mangrove propagules along the coastal area of Barangay Maglaoi, Currimao, Ilocos Norte, to restore degraded shorelines, enhance climate resilience and promote sustainable coastal resource management. The activity was spearheaded by the MMSU Sustainability and Futures Thinking (SFT) Office with the Local Government Unit of Currimao and led by Dr. Mee Jay Domingo, Vice President for Planning and Strategic Foresight.

MMSU faculty, education support personnel and students joined representatives of the Department of Environment and Natural Resources, barangay officials, members of local fisherfolk organizations and community members. SFT Director Dr. Arlene Gonzales explained that mangroves were chosen because they act as natural filters that intercept plastic waste from land before it reaches the sea, while absorbing carbon, protecting shorelines from erosion and providing habitat for marine life.

Source

- MMSU News, “MMSU plants 250 mangrove propagules in Currimao,” 11 June 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-plants-250-mangrove-propagules-in-currimao

MMSU and DENR Region 1 Strengthen Partnership for Mangrove Conservation



Dr. Arlene L. Gonzales at the MMSU–DENR Region 1 dialogue on mangrove conservation, ILAARRDEC.



MMSU and DENR Region 1 officials during the dialogue at ILAARRDEC.

MMSU, in partnership with the Department of Environment and Natural Resources (DENR) Region 1, convened a dialogue at ILAARRDEC to advance mangrove conservation and coastal resilience in the Ilocos Region through science-based and community-centered approaches. Central to the dialogue was the DOST-PCAARRD-funded nature-based solutions mangrove project led by Dr. Arlene Gonzales.

DENR officials pledged technical support and active participation in restoration, monitoring and evaluation activities. The same project brought representatives of Currimao, Pasuquin, Badoc and Burgos, with DENR-PENRO, to MMSU's mangrove propagation seminar-workshop on October 27–28, 2025.

Source

- MMSU SDG 15 Life on Land report (2025), Office of Sustainability and Futures Thinking
- MMSU News, "MMSU trains Ilocos Norte coastal towns on mangrove propagation and management," 5 November 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/article/news/2670/mmsu-trains-ilocos-norte-coastal-towns-on-mangrove-propagation-and-management

Indigenous Food Plant Foodscapes Established with Vintar and San Nicolas Partners



Partners receive indigenous food plant planting materials for the Community Foodscapes and Seedbanks, World Food Day 2025.

In October 2025, the MMSU Extension and Research Directorates partnered with local government units and schools to establish Community Foodscapes and Seedbanks for Indigenous Food Plants. Held at Eladio V. Barangan Memorial Elementary School in San Nicolas, Ilocos Norte, the activity brought together officials of Barangays San Roque and Parut, Vintar, the Municipal Agriculture Office of Vintar, agricultural extension workers, school leaders and community representatives as the second batch of partner sites.

The partner communities maintain the foodscapes as shared seedbanks and learning gardens, with planting materials and technical assistance from MMSU, to conserve indigenous food resources such as kapaskapas, alokon, pako, dalayap, wild singkamas and roselle. They join existing foodscape sites in Sarrat and Batac.

Source

- MMSU Extension Directorate, “MMSU expands indigenous food plant seedbanks and foodscapes in LGUs,” October 2025 https://extension.mmsu.edu.ph/news/show/389/mmsu-expands-indigenous-food-plant-seedbanks-and-foodscapes-in-lgus
- MMSU SDG 15 Life on Land report (2025), Office of Sustainability and Futures Thinking

A New Bambusetum in Barangay Aglipay, Pinili



Participants of the bamboo propagation, nursery and plantation management training, Brgy. Aglipay, Pinili, 2025. (Photo: MMSU)

During a two-day bamboo production training in 2025, the MMSU Extension Directorate and CAFSD, with Barangay Aglipay, Pinili, and the support of ILAARRDEC, worked with 46 farmers, local leaders and community members to establish a new bambusetum, a collection of bamboo species, in Barangay Aglipay. The training covered bamboo propagation, nursery establishment and plantation management.

Source

- MMSU News, “Sustainable livelihood: MMSU, ILAARRDEC hold bamboo training in Pinili,” 3 September 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/sustainable-livelihood-mmsu-ilaarrdec-hold-bamboo-training-in-pinili